

COLLECTION · BUYERS

Buying in Montréal

*The borough guide — finding your
neighbourhood in the city*

READ BEFORE YOU BEGIN

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Buying in Montréal

The borough guide — finding your neighbourhood in the city

Montréal is a mosaic of neighbourhoods with strong personalities: from the lively Plateau to the family-oriented areas of the west, from the charm of the Sud-Ouest to the calm of Ahuntsic. Choosing your borough means choosing a way of life.

This guide gives you a grid to compare the boroughs according to your priorities: transit, schools, atmosphere, building type, price and resale potential.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My notes” page to compare your favourite boroughs.

Montréal is a mosaic: value, atmosphere and price change from one borough — and sometimes one street — to the next. This guide helps you decode Montréal's logic, spot the family of areas that suits you and buy with resale in mind.

Take the time to go and experience the target neighbourhoods at different times: in Montréal more than anywhere, the ground tells the truth.

CHAPTER

Understanding Montréal's logic

Grasping what sets one borough apart from another.

In Montréal, everything plays out at the scale of the neighbourhood and even the street. Metro, schools, parks, commercial arteries, noise and building stock change radically within a few street corners. The same budget buys very different realities depending on the borough.

- Building type: typical plexes, condos, single-family homes depending on the area.
- Transit: proximity to the metro and major arteries, bike paths.
- Neighbourhood life: commercial arteries, parks, schools, atmosphere.

In Montréal, two properties at the same price, a few streets apart, can offer a very different quality of life: noise, parking, safety, neighbourhood life. That's why you don't buy "in Montréal" but in a specific area, which you have to go and feel on site.

EMILIE'S TIP

In Montréal, never judge a borough as a whole: walk the specific streets that interest you. Two blocks can change everything about price and atmosphere.

CHAPTER

The main families of boroughs

Spotting the style of area that suits you.

- Central and lively (Plateau-Mont-Royal, Ville-Marie, Rosemont, Villeray): urban life, transit, plexes and condos, often high prices.
- In transition / value (Sud-Ouest, Hochelaga, Verdun): dynamism, projects, appreciation potential, to be assessed area by area.
- Family and established (Ahuntsic, NDG, Saint-Léonard, eastern Rosemont): schools, parks, relative calm.
- West and English-speaking areas (West Island: Pointe-Claire, Dollard, Kirkland): single-family homes, lots, suburban feel within the city.

These groupings are benchmarks, not absolute truths: each borough contains very different micro-neighbourhoods.

Each main family of boroughs has its audience: central and lively for urban life, family areas for space and schools, transitioning neighbourhoods for potential. Identify your lifestyle first, then target the boroughs that match it — it hugely narrows the search.

EMILIE'S TIP

If you're torn between “urban life” and “family space”, it's often a sign you should clarify your lifestyle for the next 5 years before choosing the borough.

CHAPTER

Prices, taxes and Montréal specifics

Factoring in the costs and rules specific to the metropolis.

Montréal applies upper Welcome Tax brackets for higher-value properties: the bill can climb fast on an expensive purchase (see the dedicated guide). Plexes, very common, often involve existing tenants and leases to take over.

- Welcome Tax: higher Montréal brackets on large amounts.
- Plex: leases and tenants follow the building.
- Parking, snow removal, permits: urban realities to consider.

Montréal adds upper Welcome Tax brackets for high-value properties: always have the amount estimated before making an offer. Add parking (permit sticker, scarcity), snow removal and the specifics of certain boroughs to your real-cost calculation.

EMILIE'S TIP

On a high-value Montréal purchase, have the Welcome Tax estimated BEFORE making an offer: the City's upper brackets surprise many buyers.

CHAPTER

Choosing with resale in mind

Favouring areas with strong, lasting demand.

In Montréal, proximity to the metro, to good schools and to lively arteries supports value over the long term. Well-connected, sought-after areas resell faster, even when the market slows.

Watch out for nuisances that are hard to change (highway, railway, noise) which weigh on resale, even at a good purchase price.

In Montréal, proximity to the metro, to good schools and to lively arteries supports value over time. A sought-after area resells better and resists slowdowns: buy while already thinking about the next buyer, even if you plan to stay a long time.

EMILIE'S TIP

The metro is a value magnet in Montréal. At equal budget, a well-served area will protect you better at resale than a landlocked one.

CHAPTER

Montréal's housing stock: plexes and condos

Understanding the typical property types.

Montréal has a particular housing stock, marked by **plexes** (duplexes, triplexes) and **condos**, more than by the single-family home.

- **Plex:** the option to live in one unit and rent out others, but with tenant management and rental rules to know.
- **Condo:** a more accessible entry point in the city, but with fees and co-ownership life.
- **Single-family:** rarer and more expensive in the central areas.

The right choice depends on your budget, your tolerance for management and your lifestyle.

A plex can be a tremendous springboard (you live there and the rents ease the mortgage), but you become a landlord, with leases and obligations. The condo, for its part, offers a more accessible entry point in the city, at the price of fees and a co-ownership life to accept.

EMILIE'S TIP

In Montréal, a plex can be a tremendous springboard: you live on site and the rents ease your mortgage. But you become a landlord: look into your obligations before you dive in.

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

Your next steps, concretely.

This week

1. List my 3 candidate boroughs and my building type.
2. Walk the specific target streets, at different times.

Within 30 days

1. Compare the price, Welcome Tax and transit of each area.
2. Check schools, plexes/tenants and any nuisances.

Next

1. Have Emilie analyze the resale dynamics of my target boroughs.

To target my area

1. Define my priority lifestyle, then 2-3 target boroughs.
2. Visit at different times and estimate my Welcome Tax before making an offer.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Borough: an administrative division of Montréal, with its own personality.
 - Plex: a building of 2 to 4 units, very common in Montréal.
 - Upper brackets: higher Welcome Tax tiers in Montréal.
 - West Island: the western areas, largely English-speaking.
 - Structuring transit: metro and major arteries that support value.
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- Borough: an administrative division of Montréal, with its own rules and taxes.
 - Plex: duplex/triplex, common in Montréal, to occupy and/or rent out.
 - Upper brackets: Welcome Tax tiers specific to the metropolis.
 - Parking permit: a street-parking permit by area.
 - Resale potential: lasting appeal that protects value.

GOING FURTHER

Quiz — test your knowledge

1. In Montréal, the scale that matters is:

- A) The province
- B) The neighbourhood and even the street
- C) The country
- D) The continent

2. The Plateau, Villeray, Rosemont are rather:

- A) Rural
- B) Central and lively
- C) Without transit
- D) Industrial

3. The West Island is characterized by:

- A) Only towers
- B) Single-family homes, lots, a suburban feel and a strong English-speaking presence
- C) No schools
- D) No cars

4. The Welcome Tax in Montréal:

- A) Doesn't exist
- B) Has higher upper brackets
- C) Is fixed at \$100
- D) Is paid by the seller

5. Buying a Montréal plex often involves:

- A) No tenant
- B) Leases and tenants to take over
- C) Zero maintenance
- D) A tax exemption

6. What supports value over time in Montréal:

- A) Remoteness
- B) Proximity to the metro, schools and lively arteries
- C) Noise
- D) The absence of services

7. Before making an offer on an expensive purchase, you must:

- A) Ignore the taxes
- B) Estimate the Montréal Welcome Tax
- C) Pay cash
- D) Wait for winter

8. The borough groupings are:

- A) Absolute truths
- B) Benchmarks, each area having micro-neighbourhoods
- C) Pointless
- D) Set by law

Answer key

- 1. **B** — Everything changes from one street to the next (ch. 1).
- 2. **B** — Urban life, transit, plexes and condos (ch. 2).
- 3. **B** — Suburb within the city (ch. 2).
- 4. **B** — Upper tiers on large amounts (ch. 3).
- 5. **B** — Leases follow the building (ch. 3).
- 6. **B** — Connectivity and services (ch. 4).
- 7. **B** — The upper brackets surprise people (ch. 3).
- 8. **B** — Benchmarks, not absolutes (ch. 2).

Signé PAR Em

*Thank you for reading. May this guide help you
decide with confidence, with all the information
in hand.*

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